

County Commissioners Meeting July 20th, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=rJEhxJIBE_8
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Delaware County Commissioners Meeting Report

Meeting Date: July 20, 2026

Report Prepared By: Expert Civic Analyst

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

- **Session Type & Topic:** Public Hearing on the Vacation of Streets and Alleys in the former town of Mount Pleasant [00:10:32](#).
- **Summary of Discussion:** A property owner requested the vacation of old, unimproved streets and alleys originally platted in 1837 within the former town of Mount Pleasant (located on 35 South, separate from Mount Pleasant Township). Kathy Benise of Ashton Land Surveying testified that the alleys separate a house from a garage, and the streets (East Street and South Street) are unserviced and unimproved, serving to clean up old plat records. No public opposition was voiced. The board voted to close the hearing (Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote: Brand - yes, Henry - yes, Reagan - yes) [00:12:22](#).

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer Commissioner Reagan called the regular meeting of the Delaware County Commissioners to order on July 20, 2026, at 9:11

AM 00:09:47.

- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Commissioner Henry, Commissioner Brand, and Commissioner Reagan (Presiding Officer).
 - **Absent:** None noted.
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3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance 00:09:53.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** A motion was made and seconded to table the approval of the July 6th minutes. Approved by Roll Call Vote: Brand - yes, Henry - yes, Reagan - yes 00:15:12.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:13:28 Removal and Return of American Tower Lease to Table**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** John Brooks / Commissioner Brand.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board discussed the expired lease (December 31, 2025) for the American Tower site (currently housing only Verizon). Negotiations include proposing a 20-year term, increased base rent, and a 50/50 revenue share for new tenants.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Removed from table, discussed, and placed back on the table. (Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote: Henry - yes, Brand - yes, Reagan - yes) 00:14:57.
- **00:15:37 Public Presentation: Firearm Discharge Ordinances in Unincorporated Areas**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Nick Milander (Resident, 11910 West County Road 400 South).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Milander presented concerns regarding reckless target shooting near residential areas and noted that Delaware County lacks local ordinances to regulate firearm discharge for safety (exempt under state preemption laws). Commissioners directed legal counsel to research surrounding counties (e.g., Lake County) to draft a common-sense safety ordinance.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal vote taken 00:22:12.
- **00:23:24 Minor Subdivision & Right-of-Way Dedication: Dot Todo Station**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Gary Hahn (Wightman Engineering and Land Surveying) / Electric Company / Landowners Lisa Herd and Paulie Ens.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request to record the Dot Todo Station minor subdivision in Delaware Township, creating one lot for a transmission line monitoring facility,

alongside the dedication of 0.135 acres of public road right-of-way along East County Road 350 North to the county.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote: Brand - yes, Henry - yes, Reagan - yes [00:24:48](#).
- [00:32:45](#) **Delaware County Justice Center Code Compliance & Scope Preconstruction Services**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioner Brand.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed unapproved departmental expansions into unremodeled areas of the former Wilson Middle School (auditorium maintenance, clerk's records, sheriff's SWAT room, drug task force evidence room) that lack state-stamped Fire Marshal drawings.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion authorized President Reagan to negotiate a limited preconstruction services agreement with BW (original BOT contractor) to establish a guaranteed maximum price and cost projections. (Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote: Brand - yes, Henry - yes, Reagan - yes) [00:35:36](#).
- [00:35:54](#) **Unbundling of Medical, Dental, and Vision Insurance for 2027**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioner Brand / Marsh McLennan.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposal to unbundle dental and vision benefits from medical coverage for 2027, granting flexibility to employees who decline medical coverage or qualify for Medicare over age 65. The cost split will follow an 80/20 county-employee share.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved with the 80/20 split amendment by Roll Call Vote: Brand - yes, Henry - yes, Reagan - yes [00:39:15](#).
- [00:39:40](#) **Retiree Insurance Premium Adjustments**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioner Brand.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposal to shift retiree healthcare contributions to a 50/50 split effective January 1, 2027, bringing retirees in line with full-time employees and providing advance notice.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote: Brand - yes, Henry - yes, Reagan - yes [00:41:16](#).
- [00:41:23](#) **Property Access and Liability Waiver for Hyde Park Neighborhood Cleanup**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioner Brand / Highway Department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Approved a liability waiver for highway staff to access private properties on an as-needed basis during the Hyde Park community cleanup to remove curbside debris.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote: Henry - yes, Brand - yes, Reagan - yes [00:43:08](#).
- [00:43:15](#) **Right Stuff Software Hosting & Licensing Agreements**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioner Brand.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Software hosting and licensing agreement for a centralized time-tracking and PTO management system across all county departments.

Deployment is targeted for September through March. Concerns regarding automatic renewals and legal review were addressed.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved subject to legal review and modification of automatic renewal terms. (Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote: Brand - yes, Henry - yes, Reagan - yes) [00:47:45](#).
- **[00:48:55](#) Peterson Consulting Services Annual Agreement Renewal**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Auditor's Office / Commissioner Brand.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Annual renewal for capital asset list reviews ensuring compliance with state and federal capital expenditure criteria (\$4,675 from auditor contractual services).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote: Brand - yes, Henry - yes, Reagan - yes [00:49:45](#).
- **[00:51:50](#) Muncie Land Bank Tax Certificate Assignments**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Nate Howard (Muncie Land Bank).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request to assign 23 high-priority tax certificates (unsold at the 2025 tax sale, averaging 4.3 auction appearances) to the Muncie Land Bank, waiving accumulated delinquent taxes (\$382,000 total across properties).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion set a public hearing for August 17, 2026, to consider the assignment of the 23 highlighted certificates. (Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote: Henry - yes, Brand - yes, Reagan - yes) [02:02:32](#).
- **[01:03:29](#) Cowan Schools Paving Interlocal Agreement**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Highway Department / Commissioner Brand.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Interlocal agreement where Cowan Schools hires/pays for milling on Nottingham and surrounding school-adjacent roads, reimburses the county for paving supplies, and the county provides labor.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote: Brand - yes, Henry - yes, Reagan - yes [01:06:01](#).
- **[01:06:33](#) Justice Center HVAC and Backflow Repairs**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Don (Maintenance).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Quotes presented for Justice Center repairs: RTU1 smoke check unit replacement (\$1,448.04) and boiler room backflow preventer rebuild (\$1,369.51), totaling \$2,817.55.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved to be paid from the Justice Center maintenance fund by Voice Vote [01:07:31](#).
- **[01:07:45](#) Letter of Support: George and Frances Ball Foundation Promise Neighborhood**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioner Brand.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Draft letter of support for the Promise Neighborhood grant application.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote: Brand - yes, Henry - yes, Reagan - yes [01:08:27](#).

- **01:08:31 West Jackson Street Bridge Epoxy Sealer Quote**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Thompson (County Engineer).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Quote for \$15,697 from the Cumulative Bridge Fund to apply an epoxy deck sealer to the 2012 West Jackson Street Bridge as a preventative measure extending its lifespan by 8 to 12 years.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote: Brand - yes, Henry - yes, Reagan - yes **01:11:24**.
- **01:11:54 GI Consultants On-Call Agreement**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Engineer.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** On-call engineering agreement to manage and create a long-term maintenance and replacement plan for the county's 33 remaining timber-frame bridges.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved pending legal review. (Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote: Henry - yes, Brand - yes, Reagan - yes) **01:13:13**.
- **01:13:26 Warranty Deeds for County Road 775 South Realignment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Brooks / Highway Department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Acceptance of donated land parcels via warranty deeds from Daniel Wright Farms and Ricky Schaefer to widen and straighten the curve at County Road 775 South and Old Road.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote: Brand - yes, Henry - yes, Reagan - yes **01:15:00**.
- **01:15:09 Ordinance 2026-10: New Grant Fund for UDO Revision**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kylene Swackhammer (Plan Commission).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Creation of a new fund for a grant received from the Ball Brothers Foundation for the Unified Development Ordinance (UDO) revision, covering the 20% local match.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced, rules suspended, and adopted as Ordinance 2026-10 by Roll Call Vote: Brand - yes, Henry - yes, Reagan - yes **01:16:48**.
- **01:16:56 Ordinance 2026-09: Comprehensive Zoning Ordinance Amendment (Sarah's Niche)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kathy Benise (Ashton Land Surveying) & Dr. Peggy Rice.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Second reading and adoption of an ordinance rezoning split-zoned property (R1 and farming) at 6601 and 6609 East Windsor Road entirely to farming to establish "Sarah's Niche," a nonprofit dedicated to environmental and family literacy. Received a unanimous favorable recommendation from the Plan Commission.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved and adopted by Roll Call Vote: Brand - yes, Henry - yes, Reagan - yes **01:21:36**.
- **01:37:41 RFP for On-Call Mowing and Property Cleanup Services**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioner Brand.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Formalization and publication of an RFP for on-call property mowing, vegetation management, and property cleanup services in unincorporated areas.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote: Brand - yes, Henry - yes, Reagan - yes [01:37:54](#).
 - **01:41:42 Community Corrections Jail Release Program Contract Renewal**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jane Miranda (Community Corrections).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Annual renewal of the GPS monitoring jail release program contract with no price increases.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote: Henry - yes, Brand - yes [01:44:01](#).
 - **01:44:07 Community Corrections Contract with Atlas Collection**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jane Miranda.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request to enter a collection contract with Atlas Collection (Newcastle) to recover outstanding client fees dating back five years (similar to probation's recent agreement).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved pending legal review by Roll Call Vote: Brand - yes, Reagan - yes, Henry - yes [01:45:31](#).
 - **01:45:46 One-Touch Committee Appointment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board of Commissioners.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appointment of a commissioner representative to the OneTouch Initiative oversight committee dealing with time clock deployment.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Nominated and approved Commissioner Fred (Brand) by Roll Call Vote: Brand - yes, Henry - yes [01:47:34](#).
 - **01:57:35 Claims and Payroll Approvals**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioner Brand / Tanya Dunmore.
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Regular claims totaling **\$4,767,816.50** (including jail medical/food, EBT/edit funds, highway paving, veteran burials, and public safety distributions).
 - Tool allowance for highway mechanics totaling **\$2,750**.
 - ARPA claims totaling **\$71,857.00** (cost allocations and Unique Computer Services software).
 - Payroll for July 17, 2026, totaling **\$1,069,830.16**.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - Regular claims: Approved (Brand - yes, Reagan - yes; Henry voted no due to credit card claim inclusion pending review) [02:00:29](#).
 - Tool allowance: Approved by Roll Call Vote [02:03:37](#).
 - ARPA claims: Approved by Roll Call Vote: Henry - yes, Brand - yes, Reagan - yes [02:04:43](#).
 - Payroll: Approved by Roll Call Vote: Reagan - yes [02:04:51](#).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **02:05:17 George Yenser (Muncie, Newsman/Author):** Addressed county debt levels, noting the long-term financing costs of the Justice Center and the ongoing need to expand taxpaying properties to support schools and local government.
 - **02:07:21 Cheryl Dawson (4214 West State Road 28):** Spoke regarding growing public concerns over data centers across the state, noting rumors of permits near the Muncie/Delaware County airport and expressing opposition to potential power line easements on her farmland by AEP/IMMI.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Jamie Bane (Health Department Administrator) introduced Dr. David Brand as the new interim health officer following the passing of Dr. John Peterson.
 - Tommy Hubert (Highway Department) provided an operational update: 13.3 miles paved (8.2 remaining), 7 miles of chip seal completed (approx. 33 remaining, with mandatory fog sealing to follow), 38 culverts replaced, and 9 bridges under contract totaling under \$34 million.
 - Notice given regarding Form 144 salary filings due to the county fiscal body by August 20th.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was recessed/reset at 11:20 AM to transition into an unsafe housing meeting. (Approved by Roll Call Vote: Brand - yes, Henry - yes) **02:18:43**.
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